Where You Are: Priorities, the Last Part of Step Three, and What Comes After It

All nine steps of the Family Care Roadmap, and where your family is on them.

Mom is well, and your family is getting ready in its own time. It can help to see how far along that is: you're finishing the third of nine steps, and nothing after it has a date on it.

This page shows the whole road, marks where you are, and says what follows whenever the family gets there.

A note on names. The Family Care Roadmap is the nine-step map below. Your family's own future care roadmap is the page you put together in this step.

Phase 1 · Care Assessment

Understand the person, the family, and the situation.

1 **Discover** Current Situation → Concerns & Challenges → Goals & Priorities
You finish with: Family Care Starting Profile

2 **Assess** Health & Function → Safety & Support → Lifestyle & Preferences
You finish with: Personal Care Baseline and Preferences Profile

3 **Define Needs** Needs & Risks → Care Requirements → Priorities & Recommendations
You finish with: Care Needs Profile and Future Action Roadmap

You are here. This is the last part of step three: priorities. It's about sorting the preparation worth doing now from the decisions that aren't due, sharing the preparation around, and naming what would bring the family back to the plan. You finish it when the family's roadmap tells apart preparation, things to keep an eye on and action for later, with someone who has agreed to look after each and a reason to look at each again.

Phase 2 · Care Planning

Determine what good care should look like and prepare to put it in place.

4 **Explore Options** Care Setting → Provider/Facility Fit → Selection & Decision
You finish with: Preliminary Care Options Research and Decision Plan

5 **Build the Plan** Health & Personal Care → Daily Life & Quality of Life → Monitoring & Response
You finish with: Personal Care Planning File and Future Review Templates

6 **Prepare the Transition** Preparation → Move & Admission → Continuity of Care
You finish with: Transition-Readiness File and Future Handoff Template

Phase 3 · Care Management

Coordinate the plan, review what happens, and prepare the family to take the lead.

7 **Coordinate** People & Responsibilities → Communication & Handoffs → Care-Plan Alignment
You finish with: Care Team, Communication, and Meeting-Readiness Kit

8 **Monitor** Monitor → Identify & Escalate → Review & Adjust
You finish with: Monitoring, Advocacy, and Review-Readiness Kit

9 **Hand Off** Educate → Empower → Support
You finish with: Starter Family Care Playbook and Future Support Plan

What this step produces

A future care roadmap: one shared page that separates what the family is getting ready now, what it is keeping an eye on, and what it has chosen to leave for later. It records who has agreed to look after what, and when the family will look again. It is a family's plan, organized. It isn't an assessment, and it doesn't commit Mom to anything.

AARP's planning guide says a family plan doesn't have to be extensive or fancy, and that it should include immediate needs as well as the future. [1]

What happens next

This part closes step three and, with it, the first phase, Care Assessment. The next phase opens with Explore Options, which looks at care settings and how well a provider or a place would fit. For a family planning ahead there's no date on that step. It follows whenever the family gets there.

Until then, the page from this step is something to keep current. The CDC's advice for a care plan is to update it every year, or more often if the person's health or medicines change. AARP's guide tells families to be open to modifications, because how a person's needs unfold may differ from what was expected. [2] [1]

Who is involved, by role

- You and your family: sorting, sharing the preparation around, and keeping the page current.
- Mom: what she wants, in her own words, kept separate from what the family hopes for.
- Her doctor and other clinicians: anything about her health, and what any change means medically.
- Your care consultant: reviews the order of things with the family, identifies which professionals need to be involved, and helps set early family roles without loading everything onto one person.

What this page doesn't promise

A timetable, anyone's availability, or how things turn out. A family planning ahead may stay at this step for a long while, and that's fine.

Ready for the next step?

You can see where this step sits and what follows it. The care interview is how the family puts today on record before going further: it walks you through Mom's situation area by area and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The nine steps are the Family Care Roadmap's own. The advice about keeping a plan simple, open to change and up to date is AARP's and the CDC's.

1. AARP, Prepare to Care: A Planning Guide for Families
2. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, Steps for Creating and Maintaining a Care Plan